

“MANY WILL TRAVEL AND KNOWLEDGE WILL BE INCREASED.”

Francis Bacon, English philosopher, from *Novum Organum*, 1620

Novum Organum, one of the great books of philosophy, was written by English philosopher and scientist Francis Bacon (1561–1626) in 1620. It was a major work in the development of scientific method.

The initial phase of the Thirty Years' War climaxed in the **Battle of White Mountain** in November 1620, when the forces of Holy Roman Emperor Ferdinand II decisively routed those of the Calvinist Frederick V (1596–1632), ruler of what was called the Palatinate, in southwest Germany. **Ferdinand's victory** over Frederick had almost exactly the opposite effect from what he

might have expected. It galvanized Protestant opposition to him, importantly including Denmark.

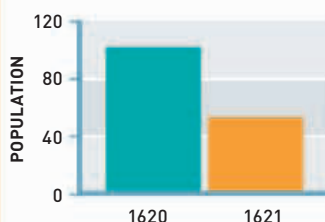
The founding of Jamestown in 1607 as the first permanent **English colony** in the New World was overshadowed by the arrival near modern Boston in November 1620 of the *Mayflower*. The 102 passengers on board were **Puritan pilgrims**, Protestant self-exiles staking all on a new life in a new world.

Battle of White Mountain

This major engagement—a Catholic victory—took place near Prague, and ended the first, or Bohemian, period in the Thirty Years' War.



American Indians of the Powhatan attack a farm in the English colony of Virginia in 1622, massacring all of its inhabitants.



Population of Plymouth

The population of Plymouth Colony dropped dramatically in the first, difficult year of its founding.

THE PURITAN PILGRIMS of the *Mayflower* had arrived in the New World in 1620 not only late in the year, with the New England winter settling in, but in the wrong place: their original goal was the Hudson River, several hundred miles to the south. Their **early survival** at what they named Plymouth Colony was almost entirely a **matter of luck**, a harsh winter survived largely through American Indian aid. Thereafter, they scraped a **desperate existence**, dependent on uncertain reinforcement from England and their own meagre efforts.

The **expiration in 1621 of the Twelve-Year Truce** between Spain and the Dutch Republic in 1609 was, perhaps predictably, the signal for a further round of **Spanish–Dutch conflict**. Both sides had increased their armies and navies in expectation of a resumption of the war. In addition, Dutch financial if not military help to Frederick V—now in exile in the Dutch Republic after his crushing defeat at White Mountain the year before—provided an obvious motive for **renewed Spanish**

hostility. Yet the subsequent fighting was less an attempt by Spain at the reconquest of the Dutch so much as an **effort to destabilize them politically and economically** by attempts to ban Dutch mercantile activities and to blockade their principal ports. The Spanish were successful in besieging Jülich and Steenberg in 1622 but an attempted siege of Bergen-op-Zoom had to be abandoned at huge cost.

The **Banda Islands**, in the East Indies, were the only known **sources of nutmeg and mace**, spices that commanded a huge premium in Europe. They were accordingly the focus of bitter, often **violent rivalry**, first between the Portuguese and the Dutch and, by the early 17th century, between the English and the Dutch. In 1621, having ousted the English from the islands, the Dutch, actively encouraged by the Governor-General of the East Indies, Jan Pieterszoon Coen, set about the **extermination of the islanders**. It is estimated that of a population of 15,000, all but 1,000 were killed or expelled.

On March 22, 1622, the **Powhatan American Indians** in what was now the English colony of Virginia, **killed 347 of the settlers**—men, women, and children—approximately 25 percent of the total number of colonists. As early as 1610, **tensions** between the settlers and the American Indians had flared into **open conflict**. By 1622, the Indians, realizing that when the settlers claimed to want peaceful

relations with the Powhatan they meant it exclusively on their own terms, rose against them. The predictable consequence was a **violent English backlash**, which by the middle of the century had all but **eliminated the Powhatan American Indians**.

Determined to end the **power of the Janissaries**—the elite military group that formed the household troops and bodyguard of the Ottoman sultan—Osman II (1604–22) had made a dangerous enemy for himself since becoming sultan in 1618. His attempts to assert himself as an independent ruler provoked a **Jannissary uprising** that saw him imprisoned in his own palace. On May 20, 1622, the 17-year-old **sultan was murdered**, probably strangled by one of his captors.



Sultan Osman II

This equestrian portrait of gouache on paper shows the Ottoman sultan Osman II. His short, but brave, reign ended in violent tragedy.

